

DeskNest Customer Research and Feedback Analysis Handbook

Research sources, themes, semantic similarity, counts, segment comparisons, and personas.

DeskNest internal reference

Contents

1. Research sources
2. Units of analysis
3. Theme creation
4. Similar feedback written in different ways
5. Theme boundaries
6. Counts
7. Segment comparison
8. Positive feedback
9. Feature requests
10. Noise
11. Personas
12. Reporting

1. Research sources

DeskNest feedback can come from in-app forms, support tickets, app-store reviews, email feedback, surveys, interviews, operator calls, and account-team notes.

The purpose is to keep findings reviewable. A stakeholder should be able to open the supporting IDs and see why the theme was created. Broad summaries without examples or record references are difficult to trust.

Working rule

- Use the customer's wording as evidence.
- Keep similar-but-distinct problems separate when the difference matters.
- Use counts carefully.
- Preserve segment and channel context.

Example

For research sources, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

Quality check

Ask whether another person could reproduce the finding from the same dataset. If the answer depends on unstated assumptions, add the missing definition or evidence.

Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving research sources usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

The same visible symptom can come from different underlying situations. When possible, preserve the part of the journey, customer segment, channel, and original wording so a reviewer can distinguish similar-looking complaints.

What to keep with the record

- Stable feedback or source ID.
- Customer segment when known.
- Date and channel.
- Original wording.
- Relevant booking, venue, or account context when available.

Analysis example

Suppose ten customers use different phrases for the same underlying booking problem. A search for related wording can help surface the records, but the returned comments still need to be checked to make sure they really describe the same problem.

A useful theme name should describe the problem in plain language. It should be specific enough to guide action and broad enough to group genuinely similar records.

2. Units of analysis

A feedback record should represent one customer response, ticket, interview excerpt, or other stable source unit. Multiple internal notes about one ticket should not automatically become multiple customer votes.

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Example

For units of analysis, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

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Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving units of analysis usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

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A useful theme name should describe the problem in plain language. It should be specific enough to guide action and broad enough to group genuinely similar records.

3. Theme creation

Themes should describe a repeated customer problem, need, request, or positive signal in plain language.

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Working rule

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Example

For theme creation, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

Quality check

Ask whether another person could reproduce the finding from the same dataset. If the answer depends on unstated assumptions, add the missing definition or evidence.

Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving theme creation usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

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Analysis example

Suppose ten customers use different phrases for the same underlying booking problem. A search for related wording can help surface the records, but the returned comments still need to be checked to make sure they really describe the same problem.

A useful theme name should describe the problem in plain language. It should be specific enough to guide action and broad enough to group genuinely similar records.

4. Similar feedback written in different ways

Customers may describe the same issue with different words. 'The room was already taken', 'venue said nothing was free', and 'booking existed but no room was available' may need to be reviewed together.

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Working rule

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Example

For semantic similarity, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

Quality check

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Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving semantic similarity usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

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Analysis example

Suppose ten customers use different phrases for the same underlying booking problem. A search for related wording can help surface the records, but the returned comments still need to be checked to make sure they really describe the same problem.

A useful theme name should describe the problem in plain language. It should be specific enough to guide action and broad enough to group genuinely similar records.

5. Theme boundaries

Related topics are not always one theme. Delayed confirmation, duplicate booking, and unavailable inventory can occur in the same journey but represent different problems.

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Working rule

- Use the customer's wording as evidence.
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- Use counts carefully.
- Preserve segment and channel context.

Example

For theme boundaries, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

Quality check

Ask whether another person could reproduce the finding from the same dataset. If the answer depends on unstated assumptions, add the missing definition or evidence.

Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving theme boundaries usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what

happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

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Analysis example

Suppose ten customers use different phrases for the same underlying booking problem. A search for related wording can help surface the records, but the returned comments still need to be checked to make sure they really describe the same problem.

A useful theme name should describe the problem in plain language. It should be specific enough to guide action and broad enough to group genuinely similar records.

6. Counts

A theme count should be traceable to feedback IDs. When one record mentions two themes, it may appear in both depending on the analysis.

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Working rule

- Use the customer's wording as evidence.
- Keep similar-but-distinct problems separate when the difference matters.
- Use counts carefully.
- Preserve segment and channel context.

Example

For counts, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

Quality check

Ask whether another person could reproduce the finding from the same dataset. If the answer depends on unstated assumptions, add the missing definition or evidence.

Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving counts usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

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What to keep with the record

- Stable feedback or source ID.

- Customer segment when known.
- Date and channel.
- Original wording.
- Relevant booking, venue, or account context when available.

Analysis example

Suppose ten customers use different phrases for the same underlying booking problem. A search for related wording can help surface the records, but the returned comments still need to be checked to make sure they really describe the same problem.

A useful theme name should describe the problem in plain language. It should be specific enough to guide action and broad enough to group genuinely similar records.

7. Segment comparison

Compare within-segment rates when segment sizes differ. Always show the denominator or group size when presenting percentages.

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Working rule

- Use the customer's wording as evidence.
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- Use counts carefully.
- Preserve segment and channel context.

Example

For segment comparison, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

Quality check

Ask whether another person could reproduce the finding from the same dataset. If the answer depends on unstated assumptions, add the missing definition or evidence.

Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving segment comparison usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

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What to keep with the record

- Stable feedback or source ID.
- Customer segment when known.
- Date and channel.
- Original wording.
- Relevant booking, venue, or account context when available.

Analysis example

Suppose ten customers use different phrases for the same underlying booking problem. A search for related wording can help surface the records, but the returned comments still need to be checked to make sure they really describe the same problem.

A useful theme name should describe the problem in plain language. It should be specific enough to guide action and broad enough to group genuinely similar records.

8. Positive feedback

Positive signals matter because they reveal what customers value and what should not be accidentally damaged by a product change.

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Working rule

- Use the customer's wording as evidence.
- Keep similar-but-distinct problems separate when the difference matters.
- Use counts carefully.
- Preserve segment and channel context.

Example

For positive feedback, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

Quality check

Ask whether another person could reproduce the finding from the same dataset. If the answer depends on unstated assumptions, add the missing definition or evidence.

Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving positive feedback usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

The same visible symptom can come from different underlying situations. When possible, preserve the part of the journey, customer segment, channel, and original wording so a reviewer can distinguish similar-looking complaints.

What to keep with the record

- Stable feedback or source ID.
- Customer segment when known.
- Date and channel.
- Original wording.
- Relevant booking, venue, or account context when available.

Analysis example

Suppose ten customers use different phrases for the same underlying booking problem. A search for related wording can help surface the records, but the returned comments still need to be checked to make sure they really describe the same problem.

A useful theme name should describe the problem in plain language. It should be specific enough to guide action and broad enough to group genuinely similar records.

9. Feature requests

A request often suggests a solution. Research should also capture the underlying problem that made the customer ask for that feature.

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- Use counts carefully.
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Example

For feature requests, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

Quality check

Ask whether another person could reproduce the finding from the same dataset. If the answer depends on unstated assumptions, add the missing definition or evidence.

Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving feature requests usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

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Analysis example

Suppose ten customers use different phrases for the same underlying booking problem. A search for related wording can help surface the records, but the returned comments still need to be checked to make sure they really describe the same problem.

A useful theme name should describe the problem in plain language. It should be specific enough to guide action and broad enough to group genuinely similar records.

10. Noise

Very short comments, accidental submissions, off-topic venue remarks, duplicate texts, and ambiguous messages should be kept or excluded consistently.

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- Use counts carefully.
- Preserve segment and channel context.

Example

For noise, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

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11. Personas

A research persona summarizes repeated evidence from a defined segment. It should not invent unsupported demographic or lifestyle details.

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Example

For personas, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

Quality check

Ask whether another person could reproduce the finding from the same dataset. If the answer depends on unstated assumptions, add the missing definition or evidence.

Example from day-to-day use

A normal DeskNest case involving personas usually contains more context than one short label. The customer may mention the booking date, whether they were booking for themselves or a team, whether support was contacted, and what happened next. Keeping that context makes later analysis more useful than reducing the record to a single category.

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12. Reporting

A useful research summary includes the theme, plain-language explanation, count, segment context, and supporting feedback IDs.

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Example

For reporting, an analyst may start by searching for related phrases and then review the returned records before deciding which theme they support.

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